



PLAYER MOVES 2.0

Alpha Version

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What is this?
Player Moves 2.0 [Alpha Version] presents a new version of the basic Player Moves put together by Petter Nallo for playtest and feedback.



Characters, locations and incidents are portrayed from the metaphorical viewpoint of the KULT: Divinity Lost setting.



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As a creator I always tend to tweak things. You twist, turn, experiment with concepts and try different approaches. The Player Moves are something that is the most fundamental in *KULT: Divinity Lost* and I really like them. Especially when it comes to new players, you give the Player Moves sheet to the players and tell them that these are the rules that exist, not only that, they don't have to know them. They can look at them when needed. Otherwise just focusing on describing what their character is doing and the gamemaster will call for Moves when appropriate. That is, of course, if they are playing Sleepers. Aware characters will demand a bit more attention from them.

Some have said that 10 Player Moves are perhaps a bit many. And, in the beginning of *KULT* we had fewer, closer to Apocalypse World. But, then I got hell bent on the idea to have the sephiroth symbol be the attributes and represent the human essence. So Robin had to do a lot of work in spreading them out and creating new ones... sorry. I do think it works however and fits so well with the mythology.

But after using the Player Moves for many years I have started to tweak them. Make changes, redo them. And I know that others have done alternative versions as well. Among them Martin Svård, whose version has inspired mine especially when it comes to **See Through the Illusion**.

So, what I present here is a new version of the Player Moves. I am not saying that this is better, it is just "different". And another way to create the *KULT* experience. So, please try them and come with feedback of what you think.

I decided to number the Moves, I think it helps a lot with communication with the players, especially those that are new to the game. And I will go through it from 1 to 12.

1. Act Under Pressure (and the Retirement of Avoid Harm)

The move **Act Under Pressure** was previously tied to the Active Attribute **Coolness** and it was used all the time. It was a catch all move for dangerous situations. You want to sneak away from someone, roll **Act Under Pressure**. You want to grab hold of the window ledge before falling out, roll **Act Under Pressure**. It was one of the secondary attributes but none of the others could even compare to the rolls under **Coolness**. At the same time, **Avoid Harm** was a move that felt like a sad little remnant that did not really get used much.

So, here **Act Under Pressure** has been moved up to the Passive Attributes and it is now tied to **Reflexes**. **Avoid Harm** is completely scrapped. **Act Under Pressure** is now all about acting quick and using reflexes when you are under pressure. For

example, grabbing that window ledge, but also throwing yourself out of the way when someone fires a gun at you.

However, it is no longer tied to stealth. That is now a completely different move that you can read about further down.

So if there is part in a scenario or a monster description that says that the player should **Avoid Harm**, let them roll **Act Under Pressure**. I now feel there is a good balance in the three primary attributes. All of them are vital for keeping your character alive.

2. Endure Injury

This move remains largely unchanged from the original version. To me its elegance lies in giving players agency through their choices on (-9) results. What did change is the trigger, which now more clearly includes situations where the character's endurance is being tested.

3. Keep it Together

This move has gone through several iterations. While the original version worked, it always felt like something was missing. The new version brings several important changes.

For (10-14) results, I decided to remove the "distracted and get a -2" option since it proved to be the least interesting and rarely chosen. The conditions angry, sad, scared, or guilt-ridden are now presented on a single line, just to make it easier to the eye.

The (-9) result has seen more substantial changes. I often found that getting a (-9) was somewhat anticlimactic. Players would typically just take an emotional trauma (-2 **Stability**) or a life-changing trauma (-4 **Stability**) and move on. It rarely felt truly life-changing or emotional. After realizing I was constantly tweaking this move as a GM, I've formalized those adjustments. In this version, a (-9) result always inflicts -2 **Stability**, and then the GM chooses one reaction such as loss of control, or getting the player involved in picking a personal trauma, giving them input into how their character reacts.

Finally, I've added the possibility of activating a Disadvantage. This can create compelling scenes where a terrifying moment triggers something deeply personal for the character. Of course, not all Disadvantages will work in every situation, so GMs should choose what fits the moment.

4. Engage in Combat

This move continues to serve its purpose effectively, so it remains unchanged.

5. Employ Stealth

When moving **Act Under Pressure** to **Reflexes**, I needed to find a good use for **Coolness**. Since the attributes in *KULT* mirror each other (**Fortitude** mirrors **Reflexes**, **Reason** mirrors **Intuition**, etc.), I knew it had to be something that was opposite of **Violence**, and connected to the ability to stay cool since I didn't want to change the Attribute name. I went the easy route and

let it be tied to stealth. This includes everything from pickpocketing something to shadowing someone. It's a tricky move, and I'm not entirely sure if it's fully there yet since it's hard to come up with interesting consequences on the (10-14) result. But, I still think it works.

6. Influence Other

Okay, this is one of the newest, and biggest, changes. I have always disliked **Influence Other** because it is so binary. And that the options on (10-14) are hard to use in play, and can often result in that you actually don't succeed in influencing the person.

The new concept with this move is that you, as a charismatic person, know how to push people's buttons. So, in a way it is more like **Read a Person** (a Move I really like since it actually creates role-playing scenes and dialogues).

The Move now follows the concept that different people are convinced in different ways. You may not threaten the cult leader, but you might seduce or charm them. The bodyguard is fiercely loyal but doesn't seem to be the brightest of the bunch and can probably be fooled.

The player tells the GM what they want the NPCs to do, and the GM provides options based on the results of **Influence Other**. For example, a character wants to get past a nightclub bouncer and rolls **Influence Other**, which results in (15+). The GM gives the player two options: either bribe the bouncer to let them in, or lie and claim they work for the club owner. Then it's up to the player and GM to play out the scene.

When there are two options, one is preferably easier but comes with more direct consequences, while the other is more cumbersome but safer. As this is still an early iteration, feedback is appreciated.

7. Observe a Situation

An excellently crafted move that is always fun. But, I find that many of the options sort of lead to the same result. So I have trimmed the list to four quite broad results.

8. Read a Person

Another move that functions well. But, I have taken out the "How can I get you to..." and crafted that to be the **Influence Other** move.

9. See Through the Illusion

I feel that this move is never used as it is written. It says that you **See Through the Illusion** when you suffer shock and injuries or distort your senses with drugs. And if you succeed you see the truth. But, when I GM and listen to other GMs they often use it when players are in locations where the Illusion is weak, witness a horrific event, etc. It is often a tool to increase the suspense and build atmosphere. Again, here I have been heavily inspired by Martin Svärds modded version. Now the premise when you can

activate it is broader and there are some clearer results for the GM to pick from.

10. Investigate

I am still not that happy with this move. I still feel it can be better and more interesting. I did change one of the questions from "Is there something weird about this?" to "What potential obstacles and challenges might I face?" I removed the "Is there something..." because you can sort of get the same information from the "What is my gut feel..." question. Again, I still think it can be improved further.

11. Improvised Move

Sometimes no existing Move quite fits the situation. The Improvised Move serves as our "stem-cell move"—adaptable to any circumstance. The GM chooses an appropriate Attribute, the player rolls, and the GM interprets the results based on the situation. It's simple, flexible, and helps maintain game flow when unusual situations arise.

12. Helping and Hindering

The rules for Helping and Hindering in *KULT* I must say is pretty underwhelming. Often the die result for this move is meaningless. Either the player you are helping is succeeding anyway, or they roll so low so your +1 or +2 does not really offer any difference. And, it always becomes tricky for a GM to come up with consequences to a failed roll. Don't know if it is a better way to do it, but just felt it was easier to say if you help or hinder, describe how and leave it to the GM to give a bonus. Sadly it would be too unbalanced to add or subtract an Attribute. Otherwise that would have been a nice solution.

CONCLUSION

So, these are the alternative Player Moves. Of course, it is very subjective whether they actually are better. But they might be something that you can try out to see if they improve your game. Feel free to provide feedback: Did they improve your game? Did they make it worse? What would you change? Anyway, I hope you enjoy them.

• 1. Act Under Pressure

*When you do something risky, under time pressure, or try to avoid harm, explain how you act under pressure and **roll + Reflexes**:*

(15+) You do what you intended.

(10-14) You do it, but hesitate, are delayed, you partially sustain Harm or must deal with a complication – the GM reveals an unexpected outcome, a high price, or a difficult choice.

(-9) There are serious consequences, you make a mistake, or you're exposed to the danger. The GM makes a Move.

• 2. Endure Injury

*When enduring an injury or perform a dangerous or straining physical feat, **roll + Fortitude – Harm**:*

(15+) You ride out the pain and keep going.

(10-14) You are still standing, but the GM picks one condition:

◇ You are thrown off balance.

◇ You lose something.

◇ You receive a **Serious Wound**.

(-9) The injury is overwhelming. You choose if you:

◇ Are knocked out (the GM may also choose to inflict a **Serious Wound**).

◇ Receive a **Critical Wound**, but may continue to act (if you already have a **Critical Wound**, you may not choose this option again).

◇ Die.

• 3. Keep it Together

*When you exercise self-control to keep from succumbing to stress, traumatic experiences, psychic influence, or supernatural forces, **roll + Willpower**:*

(15+) You grit your teeth and stay the course.

(10-14) The effort to resist instills a condition, which remains with you until you have had time to recuperate. You get *–1 in situations where this condition would be a hindrance to you*. Choose one condition:

◇ You become either angry, sad, scared or guilt-ridden (*–1 Stability*).

◇ You become obsessed (*+1 Relation* to whatever caused the condition).

◇ You will be haunted by the experience at a later time.

(-9) The strain is too much for your mind to handle. (*–2 Stability*). And the GM chooses one reaction:

◇ Loss of control: Panic, Cower powerlessly, Flee, Faint, Irrational behavior, Overwhelming nausea, etc.

◇ Personal trauma: The player picks a condition from the **10-14** result.

◇ A Disadvantage is activated.

• 4. Engage in Combat

*When you engage an able opponent in combat, explain how and **roll + Violence**:*

(15+) You inflict damage to your opponent and avoid counterattacks.

(10-14) You inflict damage, but at a cost. The GM chooses one:

◇ You're subjected to a counterattack.

◇ You do less damage than intended.

◇ You lose something important.

◇ You expend all your ammo.

◇ You're beset by a new threat.

◇ You'll be in trouble later on.

(-9) Your attack doesn't go as anticipated. You might be subjected to bad luck, miss your target, or pay a high price for your assault. The GM makes a Move.

• 5. Employ Stealth

*When you do something employing stealth, explain how and **roll + Coolness**:*

(15+) You do what you intended.

(10-14) You do it but with a cost. The GM chooses one:

◇ It takes longer than planned.

◇ You leave something behind.

◇ You end up in a bad position.

◇ Someone gets suspicious.

◇ Something gets damaged.

(-9) Your use of stealth does not go as intended. The GM makes a Move.

INUIT

◇ divinity lost ◇

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•6. Influence Other

When you want to influence a person, state what you want them to do, **roll +Charisma**. On a success, the GM will tell you what you have to do to achieve it.

(15+) The GM gives you two options, choose one.

(10-14) The GM gives you one option.

(-9) Something goes wrong—perhaps they take offense, realize your true intentions, or make you believe you have fooled them. The GM makes a Move.

Options:

- ♦ **Charm:** Compliment/Flirt with them, Offer to spend time with them, Offer sexual favors.
- ♦ **Manipulate:** Make it sound like their idea, Exploit their fears/insecurities, Pit them against someone else.
- ♦ **Intimidate:** Invoke authority, Imply consequences/Make a veiled threat, Threaten violence.
- ♦ **Persuade:** Appeal to logic/emotions, Frame it as a favor, Promise a reward/bribe.
- ♦ **Lie:** Mislead the person, Pretend to be someone else, Fabricate a scenario.

•7. Observe a Situation

When you observe a situation, **roll +Perception**. On a success you may ask the GM questions about the current situation. When you act on these answers, gain +1 to your rolls:

(15+) Ask two questions.

(10-14) Ask one question.

(-9) You get to ask a question anyway, but you get no bonus for it and miss something, attract unwanted attention or expose yourself to danger. The GM makes a Move.

Questions:

- ♦ What is my best way through this?
- ♦ What can I use to my advantage?
- ♦ What should I be on the lookout for?
- ♦ What seems strange about this?

•8. Read a Person

When you read a person, **roll +Intuition**. On a success, you can ask the GM/player questions about their character any time during this scene:

(15+) You may ask two questions.

(10-14) You may ask one question.

(-9) The GM chooses one:

- ♦ You may ask one question anyway, but don't know if the answer is true or not.
- ♦ You completely misunderstand the situation, or the person misunderstands your intentions. The GM makes a Move.

Questions:

- ♦ Are you lying?
- ♦ How do you feel right now?
- ♦ What are you about to do?
- ♦ What do you wish I would do?

•9. See Through the Illusion

When you are in a place where the veil is weak, grappling with strong emotions, mental breakdowns or witness something horrific, **roll +Soul to See Through the Illusion**:

(15+) You glimpse the true nature of a creature, location, event, or object.

(10-14) The GM chooses one:

- ♦ You have a strong feeling that things are not what they seem to be.
- ♦ You see or sense part of the reality.
- ♦ The revelation is too much for you to handle as you perceive things as they truly are, -1 ongoing for the rest of the scene.

(-9) The GM chooses one:

- ♦ The Illusion holds you in its grip.
- ♦ You see through the illusion but at a high cost. Perhaps something senses you, or the illusion tears completely around you. The GM makes a Move.

•10. Investigate

When you investigate something, **roll +Reason**. On a success, you uncover all direct leads and may ask questions to get additional information:

(15+) You may ask two questions.

(10-14) You may ask one question. The information comes at a cost, determined by the GM, such as requiring someone or something for the answer, exposing yourself to danger, or needing to expend extra time or resources.

(-9) You may get some information anyway, but you pay a price for it. You may expose yourself to dangers or costs. The GM makes a Move.

Questions:

- ♦ How can I find out more about what I'm investigating?
- ♦ What is my gut feel about what I'm investigating?
- ♦ What potential obstacles or challenges might I face?

•11. Improvised Move

Whenever you attempt something that doesn't fit any existing moves, the GM may let you **roll +Attribute** (of the GM's choice):

(15+) You accomplish what you were trying to do.

(10-14) You accomplish what you were trying to do, but there's a complication or cost.

(-9) Things go poorly and you face unexpected consequences. The GM makes a Move.

•12. Helping or Hindering

When you help or hinder another player character's Move, explain how you do it. The GM may choose to modify the roll by +1/-1 or +2/-2 depending on the situation. Helping and hindering may put you in danger.

• Name

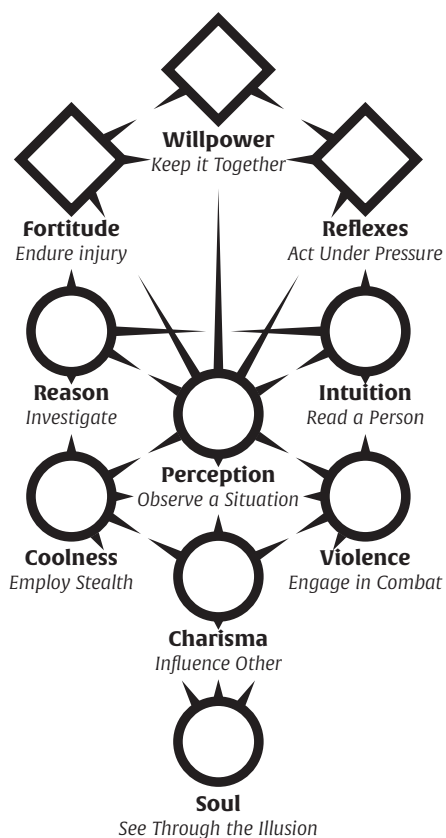
• Archetype

• Occupation

• Appearance



• Attributes



• Dark Secrets

• Disadvantages

• Advantages

• Relations

• Wounds

Serious Wounds (–1 *ongoing*) Stabilized

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	☐
	☐

Critical Wound (–1 *ongoing*) Stabilized

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• Stability

☐ <i>Composed</i>	
☐ <i>Uneasy</i>	Moderate stress:
☐ <i>Unfocused</i>	–1 to Disadvantage rolls
☐ <i>Shaken</i>	Serious stress:
☐ <i>Distressed</i>	–1 <i>Keep it Together</i>
☐ <i>Neurotic</i>	–2 to Disadvantage rolls
☐ <i>Anxious</i>	Critical stress:
☐ <i>Irrational</i>	–2 <i>Keep it Together</i>
☐ <i>Unhinged</i>	–3 to Disadvantage rolls
	+1 <i>See Through the Illusion</i>
☐ <i>Broken</i>	The GM makes a Move

• Dramatic Hooks

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• Gear

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• Notes

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• Weapons

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